

Variant 5: Prefix Expression Workbench

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1. Grammar Description (EBNF)

The workbench follows an **LL(1)** grammar designed for recursive-descent parsing, ensuring nested prefix forms are handled with absolute structural integrity.

```
Program -> StmtSeq
StmtSeq -> Expression StmtSeq | ε
Expression -> Atom | List
Atom -> number | id | boolean
List -> '(' Form ')'
Form -> operator ArgList | 'let' id Expression
ArgList -> Expression ArgList | ε
operator -> '+' | '-' | '*' | '/' | 'and' | 'or' | 'not' | '>' | '<' | '='
```

2. Token Specification

The scanner uses a **rule-based** approach to recognize tokens, distinguishing between identifiers and reserved keywords using a static mapping.

Token Type	Lexeme Pattern	Description / Literal
LPAREN / RPAREN	(,)	Expression delimiters
PLUS / MINUS	+ , -	Arithmetic operators
STAR / SLASH	* , /	Arithmetic operators
GREATER / LESS / EQUAL	> , < , =	Comparison operators
LET / AND / OR / NOT	let, and, or, not.	Language keywords
TRUE / FALSE	true , false	Boolean literals
NUMBER	[0-9]+	Integer literals
IDENTIFIER	[a-zA-Z][a-zA-Z0-9]*	Variable names

3. Java Source Code

The implementation is modularized into six core files:

- **App.java:** Acts as the main entry point, containing the automated batch testing suite and the interactive REPL (Read-Evaluate-Print Loop) mode.
- **Scanner.java:** A handwritten, rule-based lexical analyzer that converts raw source text into a list of tokens.
- **Parser.java:** A handwritten recursive-descent parser that implements the prefix expression grammar.
- **Node.java:** Defines the Abstract Syntax Tree (AST) hierarchy through an abstract base class and specific node subclasses.
- **Token.java:** A data structure used to store information about identified lexemes, their types, and literal values.
- **TokenType.java:** An enumeration defining the complete set of valid tokens recognized by the language.

4. Valid and Invalid Test Cases

The project includes a robust suite of tests implemented in `App.java` to verify both system stability and error reporting.

Category	Sample Input	Expected Behavior / Proof of Correctness
Variadic Args	(+ 10 20 30 40)	Success: Parsed as an ApplicationNode with 4 children.
Nested Expression	(* (+ 1 2) (- 10 5))	Success: Confirms recursive structure handles operators as arguments.
Variable Binding	(let x 50) (* x 2)	Success: Correctly identifies the LET keyword and builds a LetNode for identifier x.
Boolean Logic	(and true (> 10 5))	Success: Demonstrates integration of logical operators and arithmetic comparisons.
Malformed Input	(+ 5 (* 2 3)	Caught: The parser identifies the missing RPAREN and triggers a high-visibility error block: "Expect ')' after arguments."
Invalid Character	(let price \$100)	Caught: The scanner identifies \$ as an illegal character and triggers a lexical error.
Very Long Expression	(+ 10 20 30 40 50 60 70 80 90 100)	Success: Confirms the while loop logic for argument lists handles long variadic sequences.
Deeply Nested Expression	(+ 1 (+ 2 (+ 3 ...)))	Caught/Success: Verifies the recursive stability of the parser; identifies errors even at extreme depths (e.g., "Expected expression").
Complex Mixed Logic	(and true (> (* 2 5) (+ 3 4)))	Success: Confirms deep integration of arithmetic and logic within comparison forms.

Empty List	()	Caught: The parser identifies that a list was opened but closed immediately without providing a required operator. Error: "Expected an operator after '(', but found ')'."
Keyword Reservation	(let and 10)	Caught: The parser prevents using reserved keywords (e.g., and) as variable identifiers.
Keyword Reservation 2	(let let 10)	Caught: Specifically blocks the use of the let keyword as an identifier name.
Overflow Error	(+ 999999999999 1)	Caught: The scanner detects numeric literals exceeding the 32-bit integer limit (2,147,483,647).
Division by Zero	(/ 10 0)	Success (Parsed): The code builds a valid AST because the syntax is correct; literal division by zero is a semantic error outside the core front-end parsing scope.

5. AST Output Examples

The system produces a visual representation of the AST using the `prettyPrint` method. Below is the standard output for the internal batch testing suite:

• Variadic Arguments Test (+ 10 20 30 40)

```
└─ + [Operation]
    ├── 10 [Literal]
    ├── 20 [Literal]
    ├── 30 [Literal]
    └── 40 [Literal]
```

• Nested Expression Test (* (+ 1 2) (- 10 5))

```
└─ * [Operation]
    ├── + [Operation]
    │   ├── 1 [Literal]
    │   └── 2 [Literal]
    └── - [Operation]
        ├── 10 [Literal]
        └── 5 [Literal]
```

- **Variable Binding Test (let x 50) (* x 2)**

```
└─ let (x) [Binding]
    └─ 50 [Literal]
└─ * [Operation]
    └─ x [Identifier]
    └─ 2 [Literal]
```

- **Boolean Logic Test (and true (> 10 5))**

```
└─ and [Operation]
    └─ true [Literal]
    └─ > [Operation]
        └─ 10 [Literal]
        └─ 5 [Literal]
```

- **Very Long Variadic Addition (+ 10 20 30 40 50 60 70 80 90 100)**

```
└─ + [Operation]
    └─ 10 [Literal]
    └─ 20 [Literal]
    └─ 30 [Literal]
    └─ 40 [Literal]
    └─ 50 [Literal]
    └─ 60 [Literal]
    └─ 70 [Literal]
    └─ 80 [Literal]
    └─ 90 [Literal]
    └─ 100 [Literal]
```

- **Complex Mixed Logic (and true (> (* 2 5) (+ 3 4)))**

```
└─ and [Operation]
    └─ true [Literal]
    └─ > [Operation]
        └─ * [Operation]
            └─ 2 [Literal]
            └─ 5 [Literal]
        └─ + [Operation]
            └─ 3 [Literal]
            └─ 4 [Literal]
```

6. Short Design Report

- **Scanner Independence:** The `Scanner` class operates as a distinct module, processing raw source strings into a `List<Token>` before parsing begins. This separation follows professional standards by decoupling lexical analysis from syntax analysis, enabling independent testing and clear error reporting.
- **Recursive Structure:** To manage the LISP-like nested syntax, the parser uses a Top-Down Recursive Descent strategy. The implementation relies on a recursive relationship where `expression()` calls `list()`, which in turn recursively calls `expression()` to handle variadic arguments, allowing the workbench to process deep nesting without structural failure.
- **AST Hierarchy & Polymorphism:** The tree is built using a polymorphic `Node` base class. Subclasses such as `LiteralNode`, `IdNode`, `ApplicationNode`, and `LetNode` handle diverse data types through a unified interface, with each implementing its own `prettyPrint` logic for visual terminal output.
- **Terminal Readability & Indentation:** To ensure demo readiness, the system uses a standardized `INDENT` constant. This indentation is passed through recursive `prettyPrint` calls so that deeply nested trees remain visually aligned for the user.
- **Front-End Robustness & Scope:** The project prioritizes high-integrity syntax and lexical analysis.
 - **High-Visibility Diagnostics:** Both lexical and syntax errors trigger high-visibility blocks with exclamation-point borders (!!!) to ensure they are noticed during live use.
 - **Semantic vs. Syntax Scope:** While the language parses division, literal division by zero (e.g., `( / 10 0 )`) is classified as a Semantic Error. Such cases are out of scope for this workbench, which focuses on structural parsing rather than final evaluation.

7. Demo Description

- **Interactive REPL Mode:** The workbench provides a live environment for Construction construction exploring prefix expression parsing and AST construction.
- **Launch Phase (System Audit):** Upon execution, the system runs an automated batch testing suite. This includes stress tests for deep recursive nesting (e.g., `(+ 1 (+ 2 (+ 3 . . . ) ) )`) to prove the stability of the recursive-descent logic.
- **Interaction Phase:** After the audit, the program enters a persistent loop where users can input custom expressions, including variable bindings like `(let x 50)` or logical comparisons.
- **Indented Feedback Loop:** For every valid input, the system displays two levels of feedback:
 1. **The Token Stream:** A table showing `TokenType`, lexemes, and interpreted literals.
 2. **The Visual AST:** A graphical tree representation of the expression structure.
- **Readability:** All feedback is indented by four spaces to keep compiler output distinct from user input and terminal labels.
- **High-Visibility Error Handling:** The system treats lexical errors (e.g., unexpected characters or integer overflow) and syntax errors as high-priority events. These trigger diagnostic blocks wrapped in exclamation-point borders (!!!), identifying exactly where input was blocked while keeping the REPL active.

```
=====
REPL MODE ACTIVE: Type any expression to test.
Type 'exit' to quit.
=====
```

```
prefix >
```

